## 1. Purpose

To eliminate the risk of physical, biological, and chemical contamination caused by the introduction of personal belongings, outside food, and unapproved items into active food handling areas.

## 2. Scope

It governs the control and management of all non-essential personal items for every individual entering the facility's preparation, storage, and service environments—including full-time employees, management, external contractors, and visitors. This policy applies universally across all high-risk zones, such as food preparation lines, walk-in refrigeration units, dry storage areas, and dishwashing stations, from the moment an individual enters the premises until their departure. By defining strict parameters for the storage and restriction of electronics, jewelry, personal attire, and grooming products, this scope ensures a comprehensive barrier against physical, chemical, and biological contamination, maintaining the integrity of the kitchen preparation at every touchpoint.

## 3. Responsibilities

### 3.1. All Kitchen, Server, and Sauce Master Employees

Shall ensure all personal items are securely stored in personal lockers prior to washing hands and beginning their shift.

### 3.2. Kitchen Captain and/or Shift Manager

Shall conduct visual inspections during the pre-shift briefing to ensure compliance with the jewelry, cosmetic, uniform, and personal effects policies.

### 3.3. Quality Assurance

Shall periodically inspect locker rooms for sanitation and verifying that no personal items are present during facility walk-throughs.

## 4. Definition of Terms

- **Personal Effects**: Non-essential personal items belonging to staff or visitors, including but not limited to electronic cigarettes, nail clippers, money, coins, bags, and outerwear.
- **High-Risk Zones**: Critical facility areas where open food is handled, processed, or stored, including food preparation lines, walk-in refrigeration units, dry storage areas, and dishwashing stations.
- **Bare Below the Elbows**: A strict kitchen hygiene standard requiring the removal of all watches, bracelets, and gemstone rings to ensure proper hand and wrist washing and minimize contamination risks.
- **Sensory Taint**: The undesirable alteration of a food product's natural smell or taste, typically occurring when volatile organic compounds from strong perfumes or scented lotions are absorbed by high-fat foods.
- **Airborne Migration**: The movement of fine, uncontained particles (such as loose glitter, shimmer, or heavy powders) through the air, creating a high probability of physical food contamination.

## 5. Locker Storage and Uniform Transition

**5.1.** Before clocking into a workstation and entering the kitchen, all employees must store their personal effects (e.g. e-cigarettes, nail clippers, and money and coins) in their assigned lockers

**5.2.** For store employees, uniforms must be put on after arriving at the facility. Store employees should not wear their uniforms (e.g. server and chefs' uniform) or aprons during their commute

**5.3.** Lockers must be kept clean, free of rotting food, and secured with a lock

## 6. Cosmetic and Grooming Standard

**6.1.** **Standard Makeup:** Foundation and concealer applications must be light and thoroughly blended to prevent surface transfer; heavy or "cakey" cosmetic formulations are strictly prohibited to maintain professional hygiene standards. To mitigate the risk of physical contamination, all eye makeup must be water-resistant and non-flaking, while eye shadows containing loose glitter, shimmer particles, or heavy powders are forbidden due to their high propensity for airborne migration into food products. Furthermore, employees should only use tinted lip balms or transfer-resistant, long-wear lipsticks; glossy or sticky lip products must be avoided to prevent cross-contamination with tasting implements and other food-contact surfaces.

- False eyelashes and eyelash extensions are strictly prohibited in all food handling areas. They are high-risk physical contaminants that can easily detach due to heat, steam, or perspiration.

**6.2.** **Fragrance and Scents:** Perfumes and lotions with strong scents are prohibited. Volatile organic compounds in perfumes can be absorbed by high-fat foods, leading to sensory taint. For lotions, only unscented, food-grade hand creams are permitted if used during shifts to prevent skin cracking.

**6.3.** **Non-Compliance:** If an employee arrives with heavy glitter or false lashes, they must be sent to the employee locker room to remove the products before starting their shift. In the event of contamination by a false eyelash or cosmetic flake, the entire batch/plate/hotpot must be discarded, and a formal Incident Report must be filed.

## 7. Jewelry Policy (Bare Below the Elbows)

**7.1.** **Watches and Bracelets:** Strictly prohibited, except for Receptionists. These harbor bacteria and prevent proper hand and wrist washing

**7.2.** **Rings:** All rings, engagement rings with stones are prohibited due to the risk of stones falling into food and bacteria accumulating underneath

**7.3.** **Piercings:** Facial and ear piercings must be removed or securely covered with a brightly colored, metal-detectable plaster to prevent physical contamination

## 8. Mobile Phones and Electronics

**8.1.** Personal mobile phones are strictly prohibited in all food preparation and storage areas

**8.2.** If an employee needs to make an emergency call, they must step off the line, remove their apron, and go to the designated break area.

**8.3.** Upon returning from using a personal device, employees must perform complete handwashing protocol before resuming work

**9. Outside Food, Beverages, and Medication**

**9.1.** **Food:** Employees may not bring outside food into the kitchen or eat while on the prep line. All meals must be consumed in the employee breakroom or outside dine-in tables.

**9.2.** **Beverages:** Hydration is permitted only through company-approved tumblers with secured lids and straws. These must be stored on a designated shelf located below and away from any food prep surfaces to prevent spills.

**9.3.** **Medication:** Routine medications must remain in employee lockers. Emergency medications (e.g. EpiPens, asthma inhalers) must be cleared to the Kitchen Captain/ Shift Managers and stored on a designated, secure first-aid box on the floor—never in uniform pockets

**10. External Visitors**

All external visitors—including contractors, vendors, government auditors, and authorized guests—are strictly required to adhere to the company's personal effects protocols as a condition of entry into food-safe zones. Prior to accessing any kitchen or storage areas, all visitors must relinquish personal belongings—including outerwear, bags, and mobile communication devices—to the designated secure storage or visitor lockers. The use of personal electronics, including cameras and recording equipment, is strictly prohibited unless specific authorization is granted for auditing or maintenance purposes. Furthermore, all visitors must undergo a pre-entry screening to ensure the removal of prohibited jewelry and the application of required Personal Protective Equipment (PPE). Compliance with these standards is non-negotiable.

**11. Corrective Actions**

**11.1.** **First Offense:** The Shift or Restaurant Manager will immediately instruct the store employee to stop work, wash their hands, and secure the item in their locker. A verbal warning will be issued.

**11.2.** **Recurring Offenses:** Documented retraining on hygiene policies and formal disciplinary action, logged in the employee's personnel file.

**11.3.** **Contamination Event:** If a personal item (e.g. phone or jewelry piece) falls into food or a prep area, the affected food batch must be immediately condemned, discarded, and documented ***(IKQA-WI#005: Product Disposal)***.

**12. Verification**

To ensure ongoing adherence to this policy, a multi-tiered system of daily and routine monitoring protocols is established. Kitchen Captains and Shift Managers perform visual evaluations during every pre-shift briefing to confirm that all employees are clear of restricted cosmetics, jewelry, and personal items before entering high-risk stations. To validate these daily checks, Quality Assurance executes routine, unannounced store facility walk-throughs and employee changing area audits to guarantee personal belongings are properly stored and changing areas remain sanitary. Any discovered policy breaches, necessary corrective coaching, or physical contamination events must be formally recorded via official Incident Reports and documented within the respective employee's file to support operational accountability.

## 13. Change History

| Revision No.: | Revision Date: | Author & Position: | Purpose of Revision |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | February 26, 2026 | Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA/RND Specialist** | Originator |
| 1 | March 05, 2026 | Marielle Louise Macabale**, QA/ RND Specialist** | • Change the addressing of personnel; staff members to employees<br>• Added additional signatory; L&D Manager |
| 2 | June 3, 2026 | Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist** | • Added Definition of Terms and Verification |
| | | | |
| | | | |

| | Name | Position | Signature with Date |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Prepared by** | Marielle Louise Macabale | QA/RND Specialist | |
| | Celine Joy Sanchez | QA Specialist | |
| **Reviewed by** | Jackquelyn Aquino | SCM Manager | |
| | Virna Joy Bernardo | L&D Manager | |
| | Anthony Co | HR Manager | |
| | Aries Tambasacan | Operations Manager | |
| | Eric Co | Vice President | |
| **Approved by** | Jack Julius Tiu | President | |